

What Really Works

Objective Role

Evaluation: **Independent,** standardised job evaluation tools to remove bias from senior-level pay decisions

Performance & Risk-

Based Incentives: **Clear,** measurable KPIs—financial, strategic, risk, and ESG—tied to both short- and long-term rewards

Annual Pay Equity Audits:

External, data-backed audits to detect and fix gender pay gaps proactively

De-biased Promotions

& Reviews: **Structured,** transparent evaluation processes that reduce manager discretion and hidden biases

CEO Accountability for Diversity: **Linking top** leadership compensation to diversity and gender representation goals

Pay Transparency Practices:

Clear communication on how pay is set, why gaps exist, and what is being done to close them

Inclusive Leadership Pipelines:

Structured career paths, leadership development, and reintegration programmes for returning women

Culture of Sponsorship:

Managers actively advocating for women, amplifying visibility, and enabling access to high-value roles

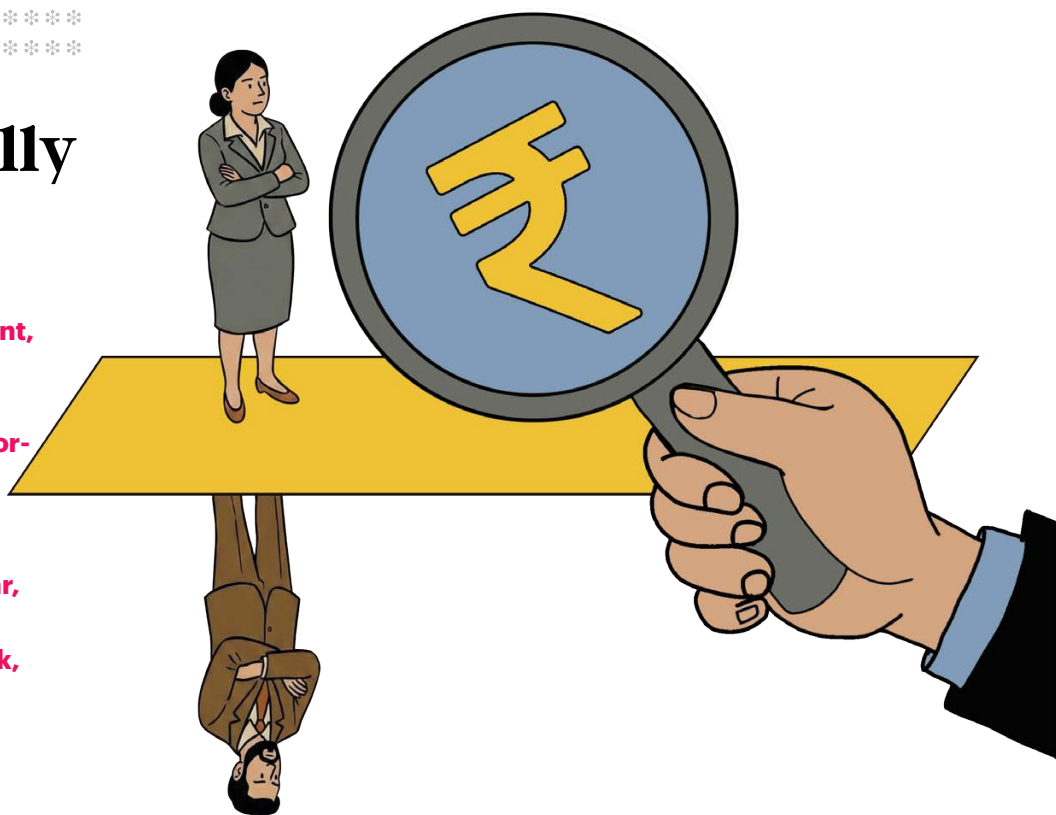


ILLUSTRATION BY **RAJ VERMA**

think tank redefining the future of work, and former Senior Partner at Deloitte. She is also a board member and TED speaker championing new voices in leadership.

ALL THE PAY, NONE OF THE PARITY

The current state of pay parity for women leaders in corporate India is improving, but there's still a long way to go, particularly when you look beyond headline data and consider structural, role-based, and hierarchical inequities.

Although India has made strides in promoting women to boardrooms and C-suites, the gender pay gap persists at mid-senior and leadership levels. A review of Business Responsibility and Sustainability Reporting (BRSR) data by Aon shows a significant unadjusted pay gap between male and female directors and key managerial personnel (KMPs) across Indian listed companies.

"The median pay gap at these leadership roles is much wider than among general employees and work-